# Proton Contacts for Business

Product Task: Sherry Bond, October 2026

**Resources**

The main source for visuals and additional info:

https://shez-deploys.github.io/pm-task/index.html

**AI Transparency**

This document was written by a human.

- All code was deployed to my github repo manually.
- Claude Opus 5.5 was used to generate the design system and translate my figma scratchpads, spreadsheets and additional writings into a website.
- All PII used is entirely fictional.
- Claude paid subscription with model training disabled
- The project will be removed/privated on my repo post interview.

## 1. Challenge & Strategy

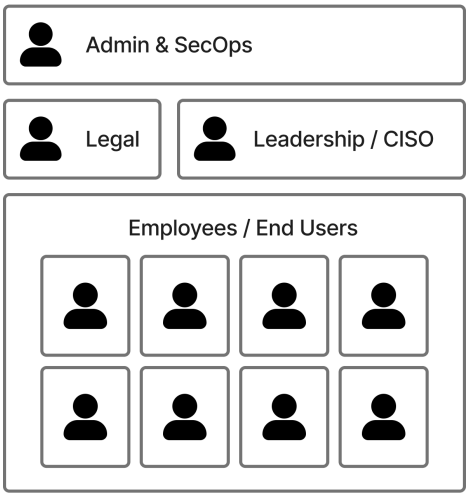
In this exercise, we will explore **how contacts can be essential in building a trust first solution across an entire business suite**. Contacts move from an address book to the context and trust layer behind every person shown in Proton, colleagues and outside contacts alike.

The challenge is composed of three components:

1. How can we utilise **Contacts** to connect the Proton Business Suite across applications and bring a more mature B2B solution to market.
2. How can we differentiate ourselves within an oligopoly?
3. How can we bring platform-wide intelligence without compromising privacy?

↗ OPTIONAL: DETAILS, ASSUMPTIONS ETC

## Personas & Market




**COMPANIES**

SMB

*More likely to use one solution as a suite, if directory and protection elevates through buying more Proton products, more likely to become the primary provider.*

***Core business metric***
*Cross-sell, potential additional cyber security budget.*

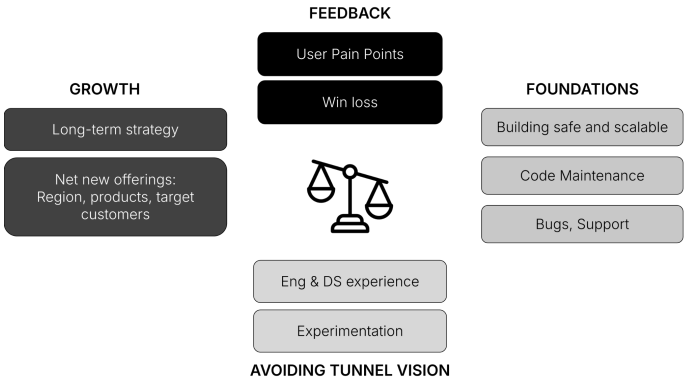
ENTERPRISE

*Unlikely to fully transition to Proton for full suite across all users, assumption is that Proton is run alongside MS / Google.*

***Core business metric***
*Seat expansion, use cases*

# 2. Backlog & Prioritisation

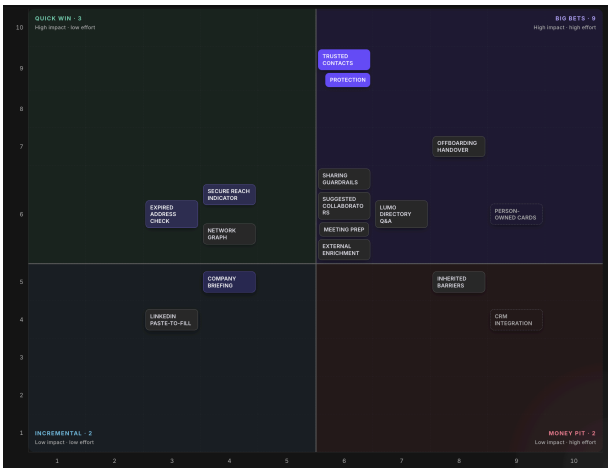
↗ ENLARGE IMAGE



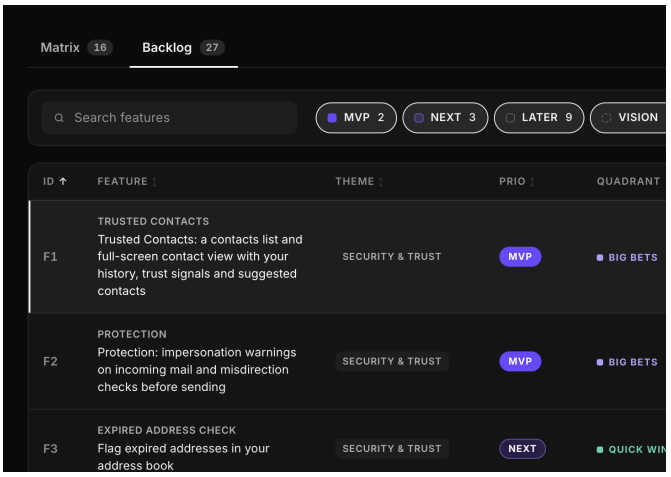

In a realistic scenario a blend of win-loss, analytics and customer discovery would contribute to us generating an understanding of hurdles for users, administrators and buyers. Once these are established, we weigh them against our strategic direction.

Based on the pain points I brainstormed a few potential candidates, using import/effort to evaluate their impact in the challenge outlined.

↗ GO TO IMPACT MATRIX




↗ GO TO BACKLOG




***Note on AI usage***: *Full Backlog and Impact Effort sources can be seen in attached spreadsheet, AI was used to visualise thereafter:* *PM: Contacts Feature at Proton*

# 3. MVP, Mockups & Delivery

Prioritisation produced two features, of which we will focus on the first "**Trusted Contacts**". Both are built on the same thing: the contacts you already have, enriched on your device with your own history.

Additionally, this will unlock countless cross-functional features across the Proton suite, enabling us to build a reliable engine for our agents to be more precise ad contextual.

| NOW (MVP) | NEXT |
|---|---|
| 1. TRUSTED CONTACTS | 2. PROTECTION |
| A contacts list and a cross-suite contact view with your history, trust signals and suggested contacts | Warnings when the wrong person is involved: a sender posing as a contact, or an email about to reach the wrong person |

## [MVP] Project 1: Trusted Contacts

**↗ TRUSTED CONTACTS: INTERACTIVE MOCKUP**

**Other workspaces know who to message, Proton knows who to trust.**

Contacts stop being a list of names. Every person comes with your shared history and the signals that show whether they are who they claim to be.

| PART | FUNCTIONALITY |
|---|---|
| Contacts list | Everyone with company, groups, last contact, history counts and trust status. Hover for a quick summary card. |
| Contact view | Opens full screen instead of a modal, with Overview, Notes, Email, Calendar, Files and Connections tabs |
| Trust signals | A checklist: domain verified, key verified, known since, consistent sender |
| Suggested contacts | People you write to often but haven't saved, ranked by confidence. Look-alike addresses are never suggested. |
| | Descoped items here |

## [NEXT] Project 2: Protection

**↗ PROTECTION: INTERACTIVE MOCKUP**

Not a full focus for this task, but a point on vision. The same contact data protects in both directions: incoming mail is checked against the people you already know, and outgoing mail against who you usually send this kind of email to.

| PART | FUNCTIONALITY |
|---|---|
| Inbound: impersonation | Look-alike characters, near-miss domains, display-name spoofs, reply-to mismatches and payment requests from new senders |
| Outbound: misdirection | A recipient who looks like a contact but works at a different company, or who doesn't fit the thread, topic or attachment |
| Admin controls | Trusted domains and partner domains<br>Warn or block for each check, inbound and outbound<br>Organisation-wide reporting on warnings (counts only) |

# 4. Metrics

## Success Criteria

- **Employee:** knows who they're dealing with at a glance, in any app, without searching across Mail, Calendar and Drive.

- **Client-facing employee:** has the full history with a client or supplier in one place, and can tell a long-standing contact from a first-time sender.
- **Admin:** data protection built in, without additional SecOps load.

## Metrics

| METRIC | TARGET (ASSUMED) | MEASURE |
|---|---|---|
| Share of weekly active seats that open a contact card | **40% six months after launch** | **Counter on the device, aggregated per organisation** |
| Contact card opens per active seat per week | Rising week on week | Counter on the device |
| Apps that show the card | 5 by general availability | Release tracking |
| Contacts with at least one trust signal | 80% | Counter on the device |
| Suggested contacts accepted (contact created) | Over 30% of suggestions shown | Counter on the device |
| Time to answer "who is this and how do I know them?" | 50% faster than today | Usability sessions |

↗ MOCK ROADMAP

# Conclusion

Ultimately, whilst contacts on its own are not revolutionary, it can be an essential thread through all services Proton provides. Delivering a secure, flexible network approach may lay important foundations in how we manage external directories and employee use cases, and lay important foundations for the protection of customer data.

The challenge of avoiding diversion when building out a large product suite is a critical one to master, requiring a great product team with a great skill for collaboration. I am looking forward to chatting with all of you.